was caught by our troops during the first week of March 1969, he was so fatigued that he could not resist or fight, as they had been marching continuously for seventy-eight days. That was the first time we saw an AK-47 rifle, over four decades ago! As soon as we informed the Division HQ about the capture of an insurgent from the gang led by Mowu Angami and Issac Swu, Brigadier S.S. Malhotra, the deputy GOC, himself flew down to our Battalion HQ at Anutangre by helicopter to take him back for gaining as much information as possible, in order to plan further operations. Time was at a premium so he did not stay for more than half-an-hour or so. The brigadier congratulated the battalion for the good job done before he left.

A fine account of this operation has been written in the history of 8 Mountain Division, '…. the gang was first located on the international border by the Marathas. It was on 4 March 1969 that a commando platoon patrol of the 9 Maratha LI led by Maj. Y.S. Shinde spotted a large gang near Tinmaung on the border, due east of Zunheboto. Mowu, who could not cross in the Chakhesang country, had moved north, but was not keen to make his way in the Sema-dominated territory. It was later reported that one of his (Mowu's) men pointed a pistol at him and insisted that he cross at Tinmaung. His men were tired of carrying heavy loads up the hills and down deep gorges in the past couple of months and were keen to get some rest in their own land. They had no footwear, and their clothes were in tatters.'[3]

Finally, Mowu Angami, the C-in-C of the Naga army, and the rest of his gang were cornered at a camp near Koiboto. Many camps of the underground had already been destroyed by us as the ceasefire had been abrogated by the Nagas by getting arms from China. Mowu's complete gang was effectively cordoned off by troops of 8 Mountain Division, and nearly a fortnight later they were forced to capitulate. Once they were warned of the serious consequences if they refused, they had no choice but to surrender, which they did. There were 169 insurgents in all, and they also handed over about 100 Chinese-made AK-47 rifles, machine guns, carbines, rocket launchers, stick grenades, pistols and a lot of ammunition that they